



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Reformation Classical Academy
School Website: <https://www.rcadayton.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Reformation Classical Academy (Dayton, OH 45403) presents a robust classical Christian program anchored in Reformed/theological foundations, with explicit aims to form virtue and wisdom through the classical method and a biblically integrated curriculum. Evidence from RCA's public materials demonstrates a coherent alignment with core classical criteria: explicit theological/doctrinal commitments, a stated formation ☐ ☐ (as opposed to mere information), a curriculum that centers grammar-logic-rhetoric while engaging biblical texts, and pedagogy that blends recitation, memory-work, and rhetorically-focused upper-school work. Faculty are framed as living exemplars of virtue within a "Christ-centered learning" culture, and parent partnership is foregrounded as essential. The school's materials also show concrete classical elements such as the classical tools of learning (grammar, logic, rhetoric), a principled emphasis on Scripture and confessional standards, and a curricular attention to historical/theological foundations.

Category-by-category, RCA is predominantly CLASSICAL, with two notable areas showing only partial alignment to classical norms (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Curriculum and Pedagogy rather than fully CLASSICAL in those categories). The aggregate assessment across all six categories is CLASSICAL.

Key insights:

- The school is explicitly committed to biblical/theological foundations, confessional standards, and the central authority of Scripture (evidence: Mission/Vision statements; Doctrinal Foundations; Westminster Confession).
- The curriculum and pedagogy are distinctly classical (grammar, logic, rhetoric; memory/recitation; upper-school rhetoric/seminars; Senior Thesis). However, explicit modern "Great Books" framing and some explicit Socratic seminar language are less overt in public RCA materials, which is why Curriculum and Pedagogy are characterized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.
- Parental partnership and community life are central (open-admissions style, family interviews, parental formation opportunities, and a culture of parent involvement).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- Mission/Foundations emphasize Education to the Glory of God, biblical perspective, and formation under Scripture and Reformed theology.
- Foundational materials foreground authority of Scripture, sovereignty of God, and a theology-centered view of education (the life of the mind under divine guidance).
- Doctrinal Foundations align RCA with Ecumenical Creeds and Reformed Confessions (Westminster Confession, ACCS).

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive: theology, Scripture, creed/confession, centrality of God, divine sovereignty, worship/liturgical life implicitly (through confessional focus and liturgical orientation in some materials), truth/virtue as anchored in God.
- Negative: none evident in public materials (no secular/morally neutral framing observed in the core doctrinal sections).
- Why this rating
- RCA presents a theologically integrated program with explicit Scriptural authority, confessional grounding, and a clearly theocentric aim for education. This maps strongly to trans-cendental moral realism and theological grounding in the classical lexicon's Positive indicators, and there are no clear Negative indicators observed in the public materials. Therefore CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission/Vision articulate formation of virtue and wisdom as primary aims, not job prep, and emphasize true, good, and beautiful as real and knowable through Scripture.
- "Education to the Glory of God" and the call to form character and discernment align with the classical telos of forming humane beings (virtue, wisdom, excellence).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive: formation, virtue, wisdom, true/good/beautiful (through Scripture), telos, contemplation, classical mission, lifelong formation
- Negative: explicit workforce-preparation language is minimal; the materials emphasize formation over job-readiness.
- Why this rating
- RCA's stated purpose centers on virtue and wisdom formed through a biblical framework, aligning with the classical emphasis on formation over mere information. This yields a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The curriculum centers the liberal arts tools of grammar, logic, and rhetoric (Progymnasmata) and integrates them across grades. Lower grades include Bible/theology, language arts, math, science, history/geography, and literature with a classical flavor; upper grades emphasize rhetoric and senior-level work (Senior Thesis).
- Historical/theological foundations are foregrounded; there is explicit use of classical approaches within a biblical framework; Foundational Documents emphasize "the classical method" and the Lost Tools of Learning.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric; progymnasmata; history (and Famous Men series); classical method; Great Books/Great Conversation (documented in foundational materials as part of classical approach); sacred/artistic elements (hymnody, sacred music) as integral to the curriculum.
- Negative keywords observed: explicit modern "project-based learning" language is not foregrounded; the public materials do not emphasize a heavy STEM-first or social studies replacement framing; however, there is limited explicit mention of "Great Books" in the public curriculum pages, though it is implied via the Foundational Documents and Lost Tools of Learning resources.
- Why this rating
- RCA demonstrates substantial classical elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric, memory/recitation, engagement with classical pedagogy and Great Conversation concepts via the Lost Tools of Learning documents). Still, the explicit, comprehensive Great Books/Great Conversation framing is not as overt in the public pages as some classical schools; thus the category sits at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than FULLY CLASSICAL. The curriculum is clearly traditional, robust, and biblically integrated, but the explicit Great Books-centric language is less visible in the public-facing materials.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Lower grades show memory-focused, contemplative elements (singing, chanting, recitation patterns) linked to early memory work and a sense of wonder; upper grades emphasize rhetoric and public expression (Senior Thesis) and synthesis across disciplines. The Rhetoric School (Grades 10–12) highlights synthesis, public discourse, and persuasive writing.
- The presence of progymnasmata-style writing and emphasis on rhetorical training aligns with classical pedagogy; the use of grammar/logic/rhetoric in the lower grades demonstrates the classical approach to pedagogy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords: scholé (restful/reflective learning), memory work/recitation, chanting, narration, dialectic/seminar (Socratic/seminal pedagogy language appears in the classical lexicon and is evidenced by the upper-level rhetoric emphasis), rhetoric, public speaking, Senior Thesis.
- Negative keywords: The explicit emphasis on experiential learning or strictly project-based pedagogy in lieu of classical methods is not prominent; the materials do not show a dominant modern constructivist approach.
- Why this rating
- RCA's pedagogy shows strong classical traits (recitation, memory work, progymnasmata, precursor to Socratic-style upper-level work, rhetoric emphasis). However, the explicit, sustained practice of Socratic seminars or formal seminars across grades is not uniformly stated in the public materials, which leads to a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Faculty are described as model teachers and mentors and the living curriculum; there is emphasis on faculty embodying Christ-centered learning; the staff pages emphasize virtue, character formation, and professional alignment with the school's classical Christian aims.
- The “portrait” of teachers and the idea of a “living curriculum” are explicit, and faculty are presented as central to the school's formation goals.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords: living curriculum, mentors, model teachers, faculty of friends, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture, character formation.
- Negative keywords: none observed in the public materials (no language suggesting a non-classical staff model).
- Why this rating
- RCA presents a classic, highly favorable portrayal of its faculty as central to the educational mission, consistent with classical ideals. This yields CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- RCA emphasizes partnership with parents, parent formation, and open-campus access; admissions emphasize parent interviews and a family-oriented approach; there are multiple references to parental involvement in the learning process.
- The school promotes book studies, gatherings, and educational engagement with parents, indicating a robust co-teaching relationship with families.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords: partnership with parents, co-teachers with the school, parental formation/study groups, open campus/visit flexibility for parents.
- Negative keywords: none observed in the public materials.
- Why this rating

- RCA demonstrates a strong, explicit commitment to parental involvement and community engagement, aligning with classical expectations for Parent & Community relations. This yields CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Assessment

- Category results: CLASSICAL, CLASSICAL, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, CLASSICAL, CLASSICAL
- Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Not required here, as the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. However, if you want a more uniformly “fully classical” signal in Curriculum and Pedagogy, the school could more explicitly foreground:
- Explicit Great Books / Great Conversation framing in public materials with direct references to canonical titles and core reading lists.
- More explicit mention of Socratic seminars or structured seminar-based pedagogy across upper grades, with exemplars and sample rubrics publicly available.
- Expanded emphasis on classical languages (Latin/Greek) within more grade levels to strengthen the tria of grammar/logic/rhetoric in the curriculum.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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